Taylor Cox

Department of Political Science, University of Washington, Seattle
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Education

Ph.D. (in progress), Political Science
University of Washington

M.A., Global Policy Studies, 2023
University of Texas at Austin, LBJ School of Public Affairs
Certificate in Applied Statistical Modeling

B.A., Arabic; Peace, War, and Defense, 2021
University of North Carolina at Chapel Hill
Minor in Middle Eastern Languages; Highest Distinction and Highest Honors

Employment

Department of Defense, Presidential Management Fellow, 2023-2025
Space Systems Command, Program Manager; Center for Army Analysis, Operations Research Systems Analyst

Working Papers

Strength in Numbers? Assessing the Effectiveness of Large-Scale Drone Attacks in the Russia-Ukraine War. Taylor Cox. Working paper.

(Don't Fear) The Reaper: Bayesian Causal Forests and the Mixed Evidence for Drone Strike Effectiveness. Taylor Cox and David Puelz. Working paper.

Choose Your Battles: How Ukrainian Drone Strikes Change Where and How Russia Fights. Taylor Cox. Working paper.

Awards and Honors

Presidential Management Fellow, 2023
U.S. Office of Personnel Management

Kenneth Flamm Data Science Award, 2023
University of Texas at Austin

Grants and Fellowships

Ione E. Curtis Graduate Research Grant, 2026-2027
Department of Political Science, University of Washington, Seattle

Paul Speyer Fellowship, 2024-2025
University of Washington, Seattle

Blalock Fellowship, 2024-2025
Center for Statistics in the Social Sciences, University of Washington, Seattle

National Bureau of Asian Research Fellowship, 2022

Ann Grabhorn-Friday Endowment Fellowship, 2021-2022
University of Texas at Austin

Conference Activity / Participation

Strength in Numbers? Assessing the Effectiveness of Large-Scale Drone Attacks in the Russia-Ukraine War.
Text as Data Conference, University of California, Berkeley, 2026

Strength in Numbers? Assessing the Effectiveness of Large-Scale Drone Attacks in the Russia-Ukraine War.
Conference for Russian, East European, and Central Asian Studies, 2026

Clustering Analysis of US and Chinese UAV Technology.
UT Statistical Modeling Colloquium, 2023

Fear the Reaper: How Drone Strikes Impact Terrorist Attacks.
Texas Empirical Policy Conference; Joint Base Lewis-McChord, 2023

Do Drones Drive Violence?
Triangle Security Studies Conference, 2021

Teaching Experience

Teaching Assistant, Pol S 203: Introduction to International Relations, Autumn 2026
University of Washington; Professor Gabriella Levy

Teaching Assistant, History Department, 2021-2023
University of Texas at Austin

Academic Service

Undergraduate Program Committee Representative, 2026-2027
Department of Political Science, University of Washington

Graduate Representative, 2026-2027
Center for Statistics in the Social Sciences, University of Washington

Research Experience

Graduate Research Assistant, Salem Center for Policy Analysis, 2021-2023
University of Texas at Austin

Related Professional Skills

R; Python; LaTeX; ArcGIS Pro

Languages

Arabic: Limited working proficiency (reading, writing, speaking)
Farsi: Beginner (reading, writing)

References

Christopher Adolph
Professor of Political Science; Adjunct Professor of Statistics; Associate Director, Center for Statistics and the Social Sciences, University of Washington at Seattle
Dissertation Chair
cadolpha@uw.edu

David Puelz
Associate Professor of Statistics & Data Science, University of Austin (formerly University of Texas at Austin)
dpuelz@gmail.com

Patricia L. Sullivan
Professor of Public Policy and the Curriculum in Peace, War, and Defense; Chair, Department of Public Policy, University of North Carolina at Chapel Hill
tsulli@email.unc.edu